Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 2
♥ A J 7
♦ J 8 6 2
♣ K 6 5

♠ 8 7 5 4 3
♥ Q 10 3
♦ A 4
♣ J 10 3

♠ J 6
♥ 9 8 5 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A Q 9 8

♠ K Q 9
♥ K 6 4
♦ K Q 10 3
♣ 7 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥9

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥9, the top of nothing.

Your ♣s are so good that all your instincts tell you to lead the ♣8, and perhaps set up 3 winners.

If you had one more small ♣s your instincts would be right, but with only a 4-card suit you should think a little longer. Three tricks won't set this contract, so you must depend on partner winning something. And if partner is going to win something perhaps he will lead a ♣ and you might make FOUR tricks in the suit.

So lead the ♥9. You lead a high card so partner won't be tempted to return the suit when he gets the lead. Note that although this lead finesses partner's ♥Q, it didn't do anything that declarer wouldn't have done on his own.

Declarer must play ♦s to get some winners, and when West takes the ♦A he will surely switch to the ♣J. Down goes declarer.

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 5 ♥ K Q 9 6 3 ♦ K 6 ♣ K Q 10 9 6	
♠ K 10 8 ♥ 7 ♦ A 7 5 3 2 ♣ 8 5 3 2	N W E S	♠ Q J 9 7 6 2 ♥ A 8 5 4 ♦ 4 ♣ 7 4
	♠ A 4 3 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ Q J 10 9 8 ♣ A J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	2♠	3♦
3♠	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	Pass	4♠	Dbl
All Pass			

4♠X by East
Lead: ♠A

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♠ doubled

Lead the ♠A.

East's 2♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦Q or ♥J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal West/East have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the conract.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 6 4
♥ 6 4 2
♦ K 9 4 2
♣ A K J

♠ K 8 7 3
♥ Q 10 7 3
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3 2

♠ Q 9 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ A 8 6
♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5
♥ A J 9
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ Q 8 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♥3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice. Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠10 in dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick, which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥ winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he cannot establish the ♠ winner.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 6 3 ♥ K 6 3 ♦ A 7 4 ♣ 10 9 8 7 4	
♠ K Q J 9 5 4 ♥ A J 10 ♦ 6 ♣ A 5 2		♠ A 10 ♥ 9 4 ♦ K Q J 9 8 3 ♣ K Q J
	♠ 8 7 2 ♥ Q 8 7 5 2 ♦ 10 5 2 ♣ 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	Pass
1♠	Pass	3♦	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♠ by West
Lead: ♥3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♠

Lead the ♥3.

The ♣10 would probably be a very safe lead. But you don't want "safe", you want "attack".

Dummy has advertised a long, strong ♦ suit which declarer will no doubt establish for discards.

It is important for your side to create a winner before your ♦A is forced out. The most likely looking winner is your ♥K. So lead the small ♥ and hope partner has the Queen.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 9 7
♣ A 10 4

♠ K Q J 10 8
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 5
♣ 9 6 3

♠ 4
♥ 10 9 8 4
♦ 8 6 3 2
♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 4
♣ Q J 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Dbl			
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠4.

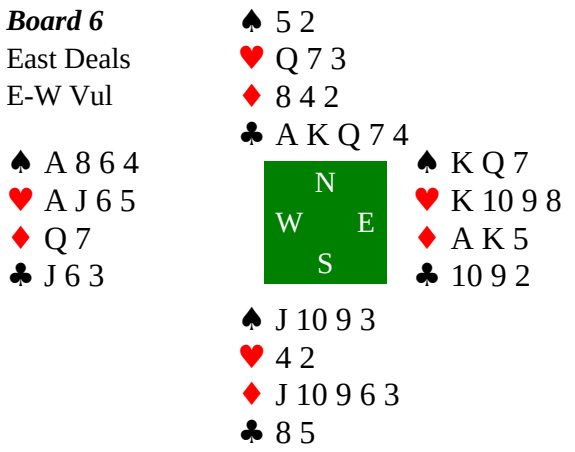
If partner had not doubled the contract you would probably have started with the ♥10, or possibly the ♣2.

But partner DID double, and most good players play that doubling 3NT is lead-directing as follows:If you have bid a suit, lead it. If doubler has bid a suit, lead it. If neither of you has bid, lead dummy's first bid suit.

So lead a ♠, certainly not a lead you would have made without the double. Partner immediately establishes 4 ♠ winners and he has the ♦A for an entry.

With any other lead declarer will make the contract.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Dbl	2♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♣8

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♥

Lead the ♣8.

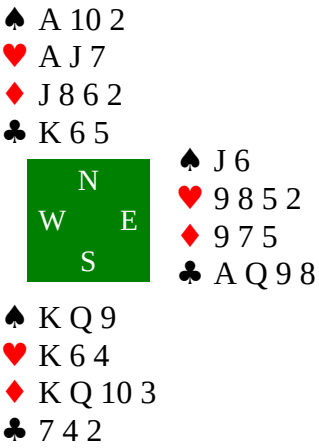
If partner had not doubled West's Stayman 2♣ bid you would probably have started with one of your Jacks.

But partner **DID** double, and the double of a conventional bid clearly means that the doubler would like you to lead that suit.

So lead a ♣, and partner will take three ♣ tricks. With any other lead declarer would quickly discard a ♣ from dummy on a high ♦, easily making the contract.

Declarer may still make the contract if he guesses the ♥Q correctly, but maybe not.

Board 7
South Deals
Both Vul



Board 8
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 5
♥ K Q 9 6 3
♦ K 6
♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ K 10 8
♥ 7
♦ A 7 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ 4
♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q J 10 9 8
♣ A J

Board 9
North Deals
E-W Vul

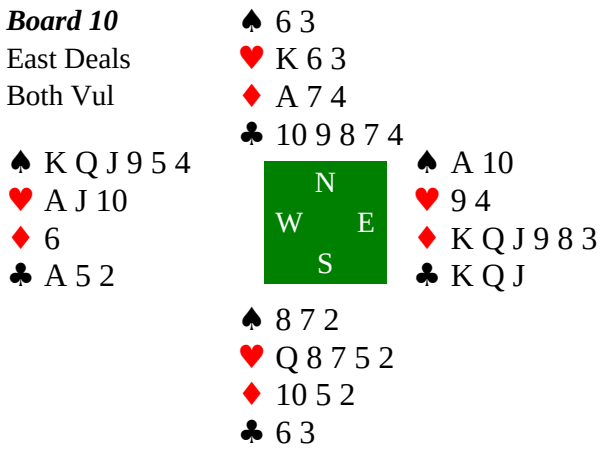
♠ 10 6 4
♥ 6 4 2
♦ K 9 4 2
♣ A K J

♠ K 8 7 3
♥ Q 10 7 3
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3 2

♠ Q 9 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ A 8 6
♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5
♥ A J 9
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ Q 8 4

Board 10
East Deals
Both Vul



Board 11
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 9 7
♣ A 10 4

♠ K Q J 10 8
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 5
♣ 9 6 3

♠ 4
♥ 10 9 8 4
♦ 8 6 3 2
♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 4
♣ Q J 5

Board 12
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 5 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ A K Q 7 4

♠ A 8 6 4
♥ A J 6 5
♦ Q 7
♣ J 6 3

♠ K Q 7
♥ K 10 9 8
♦ A K 5
♣ 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ J 10 9 6 3
♣ 8 5

Board 13
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A 10 2 ♥ A J 7 ♦ J 8 6 2 ♣ K 6 5	
♠ 8 7 5 4 3 ♥ Q 10 3 ♦ A 4 ♣ J 10 3		♠ J 6 ♥ 9 8 5 2 ♦ 9 7 5 ♣ A Q 9 8
	♠ K Q 9 ♥ K 6 4 ♦ K Q 10 3 ♣ 7 4 2	

Board 14
East Deals
None Vul

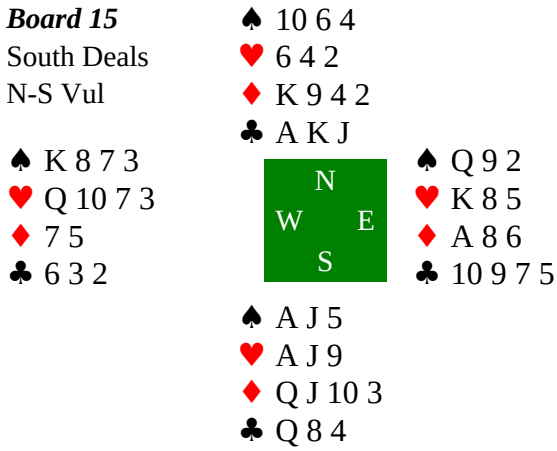
♠ 5
♥ K Q 9 6 3
♦ K 6
♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ K 10 8
♥ 7
♦ A 7 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ 4
♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q J 10 9 8
♣ A J

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul



Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 6 3
♥ K 6 3
♦ A 7 4
♣ 10 9 8 7 4

♠ K Q J 9 5 4
♥ A J 10
♦ 6
♣ A 5 2

♠ A 10
♥ 9 4
♦ K Q J 9 8 3
♣ K Q J

♠ 8 7 2
♥ Q 8 7 5 2
♦ 10 5 2
♣ 6 3

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 9 7
♣ A 10 4

♠ K Q J 10 8
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 5
♣ 9 6 3

♠ 4
♥ 10 9 8 4
♦ 8 6 3 2
♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 4
♣ Q J 5

Board 18
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 5 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ A K Q 7 4

♠ A 8 6 4
♥ A J 6 5
♦ Q 7
♣ J 6 3

♠ K Q 7
♥ K 10 9 8
♦ A K 5
♣ 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ J 10 9 6 3
♣ 8 5

Board 19
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 10 2
♥ A J 7
♦ J 8 6 2
♣ K 6 5

♠ 8 7 5 4 3
♥ Q 10 3
♦ A 4
♣ J 10 3

♠ J 6
♥ 9 8 5 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A Q 9 8

♠ K Q 9
♥ K 6 4
♦ K Q 10 3
♣ 7 4 2

Board 20
West Deals
Both Vul

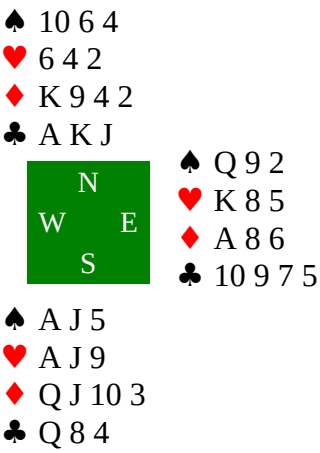
♠ 5
♥ K Q 9 6 3
♦ K 6
♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ K 10 8
♥ 7
♦ A 7 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3 2

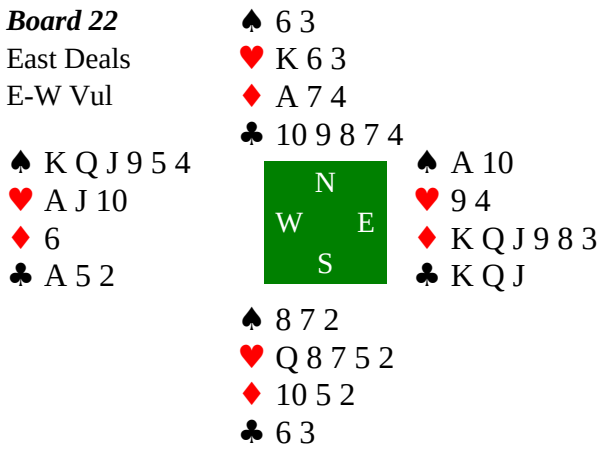
♠ Q J 9 7 6 2
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ 4
♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q J 10 9 8
♣ A J

Board 21
North Deals
N-S Vul



Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul



Board 23
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 9 7
♣ A 10 4

♠ K Q J 10 8
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 5
♣ 9 6 3

♠ 4
♥ 10 9 8 4
♦ 8 6 3 2
♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 4
♣ Q J 5

Board 24
West Deals
None Vul

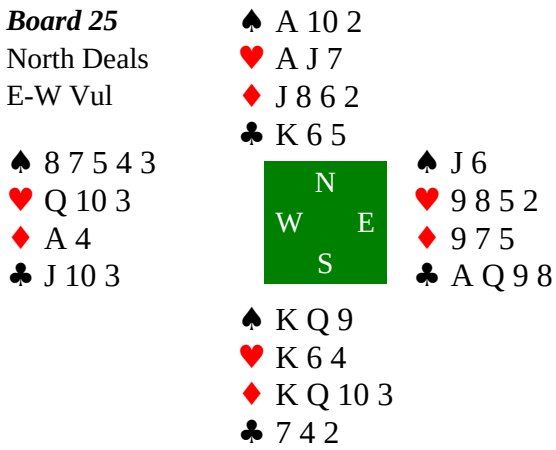
♠ 5 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ A K Q 7 4

♠ A 8 6 4
♥ A J 6 5
♦ Q 7
♣ J 6 3

♠ K Q 7
♥ K 10 9 8
♦ A K 5
♣ 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ J 10 9 6 3
♣ 8 5

Board 25
North Deals
E-W Vul



Board 26
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 5
♥ K Q 9 6 3
♦ K 6
♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ K 10 8
♥ 7
♦ A 7 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ 4
♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q J 10 9 8
♣ A J

Board 27
South Deals
None Vul

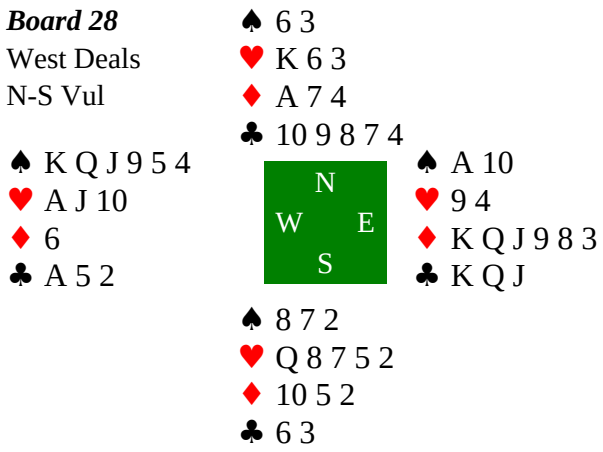
♠ 10 6 4
♥ 6 4 2
♦ K 9 4 2
♣ A K J

♠ K 8 7 3
♥ Q 10 7 3
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3 2

♠ Q 9 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ A 8 6
♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5
♥ A J 9
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ Q 8 4

Board 28
West Deals
N-S Vul



Board 29
North Deals
Both Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 9 7
♣ A 10 4

♠ K Q J 10 8
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 5
♣ 9 6 3

♠ 4
♥ 10 9 8 4
♦ 8 6 3 2
♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 4
♣ Q J 5

Board 30
East Deals
None Vul

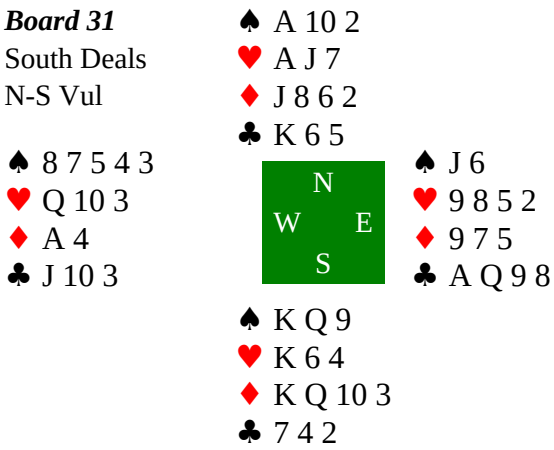
♠ 5 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ A K Q 7 4

♠ A 8 6 4
♥ A J 6 5
♦ Q 7
♣ J 6 3

♠ K Q 7
♥ K 10 9 8
♦ A K 5
♣ 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ J 10 9 6 3
♣ 8 5

Board 31
South Deals
N-S Vul



Board 32
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 5
♥ K Q 9 6 3
♦ K 6
♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ K 10 8
♥ 7
♦ A 7 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ 4
♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q J 10 9 8
♣ A J

Board 33
North Deals
None Vul

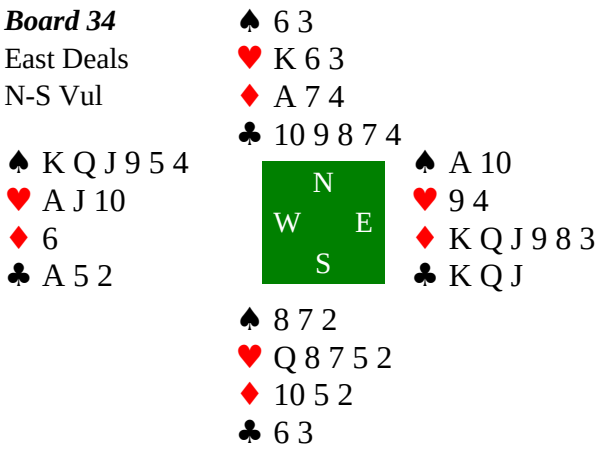
♠ 10 6 4
♥ 6 4 2
♦ K 9 4 2
♣ A K J

♠ K 8 7 3
♥ Q 10 7 3
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3 2

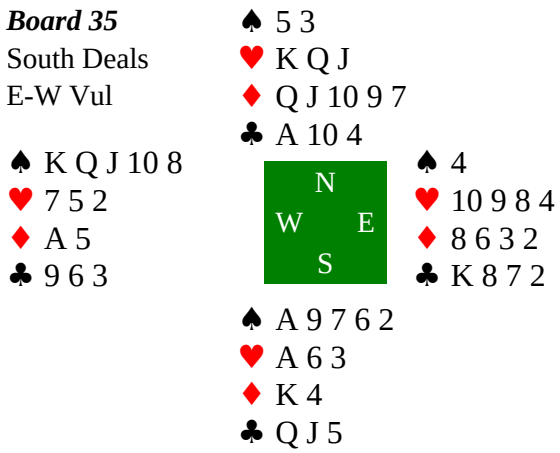
♠ Q 9 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ A 8 6
♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5
♥ A J 9
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ Q 8 4

Board 34
East Deals
N-S Vul



Board 35
South Deals
E-W Vul



Board 36
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ 5 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ A K Q 7 4

♠ A 8 6 4
♥ A J 6 5
♦ Q 7
♣ J 6 3

♠ K Q 7
♥ K 10 9 8
♦ A K 5
♣ 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ J 10 9 6 3
♣ 8 5